

Common Cold - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1390 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Qatar-localized UAT-only adult and pediatric upper-respiratory-symptom pathway screening for breathing difficulty, sepsis, dehydration and high-risk hosts; not approved for production.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How long have symptoms lasted?
2. [TEMPERATURE] What is the temperature, if measured?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Any existing chronic condition or weakened immune system?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the exact age; is the patient pregnant; and are there breathing/feeding difficulty, reduced urine, drowsiness, severe pain, prolonged fever, immune suppression or safeguarding concerns?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Nasal Allergies (Hay Fever)

Are sneezing and an itchy or runny nose mainly linked to a seasonal or environmental trigger, without an infectious illness pattern?

Symptoms primarily linked to a seasonal or environmental trigger belong in the authored Nasal Allergies (Hay Fever) pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there severe or abnormal breathing (gasping, choking, unable to speak or feed normally), blue or grey colour, collapse, confusion, unusual floppiness or difficulty waking, a seizure, or signs of severe dehydration such as no urine and marked drowsiness?

Severe breathing, circulation, responsiveness, neurological or dehydration features can indicate a life-threatening illness rather than an uncomplicated cold and require emergency assessment.

1. Disposition level 70

After emergency features are excluded, is the patient under 3 months with a measured temperature of 38 degrees Celsius or higher, age 3-6 months with a measured temperature of 39 degrees Celsius or higher, having feeding difficulty or reduced urine, or is there a high temperature lasting more than 3 days, worsening symptoms, shortness of breath or chest pain, symptoms lasting more than 10 days, a cough lasting more than 3 weeks, or an existing chronic condition or weakened immune system?

NICE treats fever at these infant age thresholds as higher risk, and NHS.UK common cold guidance lists the other features as reasons to arrange clinical review.

1. Disposition level 50

Are these typical cold symptoms with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes the common cold as self-limiting, usually improving within 1-2 weeks.

Advice

Qatar emergency response for severe respiratory illness

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now for severe or abnormal breathing, blue or grey colour, collapse, confusion, seizure, unusual floppiness or difficulty waking, or severe dehydration. Follow the call-taker's instructions and do not self-drive. If the patient becomes unresponsive and is not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed and use an AED if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: breathing or colour worsens; reduced responsiveness or seizure; no urine with marked drowsiness.

Urgent cold-with-complications review

- Arrange prompt in-person clinical assessment through the Qatar pathway approved for this UAT environment. A young infant meeting a fever threshold, or any patient with feeding, hydration, breathing or high-risk-host concerns, must not remain on routine cold self-care. The exact non-emergency destination and timeframe remain GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.
- Call Back If: breathing difficulty develops; feeding, urine or alertness worsens; symptoms significantly worsen.

Low-risk respiratory symptom review

- Rest and maintain tolerated fluids; avoid steam inhalation because of burn risk. Arrange clinician/pharmacist review before medicines are selected, especially for children or pregnancy. Escalate any breathing, feeding, hydration or responsiveness concern.
- Call Back If: fever persists or condition worsens; breathing, feeding, urine or alertness changes.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now for severe or abnormal breathing, blue or grey colour, collapse, confusion, seizure, unusual floppiness or difficulty waking, or severe dehydration. Follow the call-taker's

instructions and do not self-drive. If the patient becomes unresponsive and is not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed and use an AED if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Common cold", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/common-cold/> (page last reviewed 22 March 2024)
- NICE NG143, "Fever in under 5s: assessment and initial management", <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng143>

Provenance

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